



Go-to-Market Strategy

Nota targets an intellectually restless audience already feeling the pain of shallow reading. This GTM strategy exploits word-of-mouth dynamics rather than fighting them through paid acquisition.



Phase 1: Seeding with the Right 500

Months 1-4

Launch invite-only with precision. Target Substack writers with engaged comment sections, podcast hosts annotating research, academics frustrated with shallow discourse. Frame as "we built something for people who think the way you do."

Deep Usage

Generate quality annotation data for cognitive fingerprint training

Public Advocacy

Talk about it in ways that make others feel seen

📋 **Seeding Metric:** Annotations per active user per week, not user count. If the first 500 aren't annotating, the product isn't working.

Phase 2: The Confluence Flywheel

Months 4-10

Confluence requires density on the same passages. Partner with 3–5 Substack writers whose audiences already annotate PDFs. Offer "Nota for your readers" pages — every reader gets early access, creating natural confluence density fast.

Convert from "interesting tool" to "the reason I come back." Engineer the magic moment (finding a glow on a passage) rather than leaving it to chance.



Phase 3: Institutional and Premium

Months 10-18

1

Personal Premium

Cognitive profile depth, unlimited annotations, private weekly digest

2

Institutional Tier

Research groups, book clubs, MBA cohorts, writing residencies

The institutional path has high willingness to pay and brings cohorts who share content, accelerating confluence density without acquisition cost.



Why This Strategy Fits the Product's Soul

No Virality Loops

No follower counts, shares, or feed.
Paid acquisition would hit a wall — no K-factor to amplify.

Authentic Social Proof

Confluence discovery creates deeply personal moments that generate authentic word-of-mouth: "I found this thing where my friend and I highlighted the same exact sentence."

High-Intent Audience

Seeding with high-signal users and letting them generate authentic spread is the only GTM that fits Nota's product philosophy.



Metrics

North Star Metric

Weekly Active Annotators

The number of users who add at least one tagged annotation in a given week.



Core Value Exchange

Annotation with a thought tag feeds the cognitive fingerprint and triggers confluence matching



Product Actually Working

Turns a reader into a thinker.
Casual readers who never annotate are not using Nota



Distinguishing Metric

Separates active users from passive readers using a worse Pocket

L1 Metrics: Activation

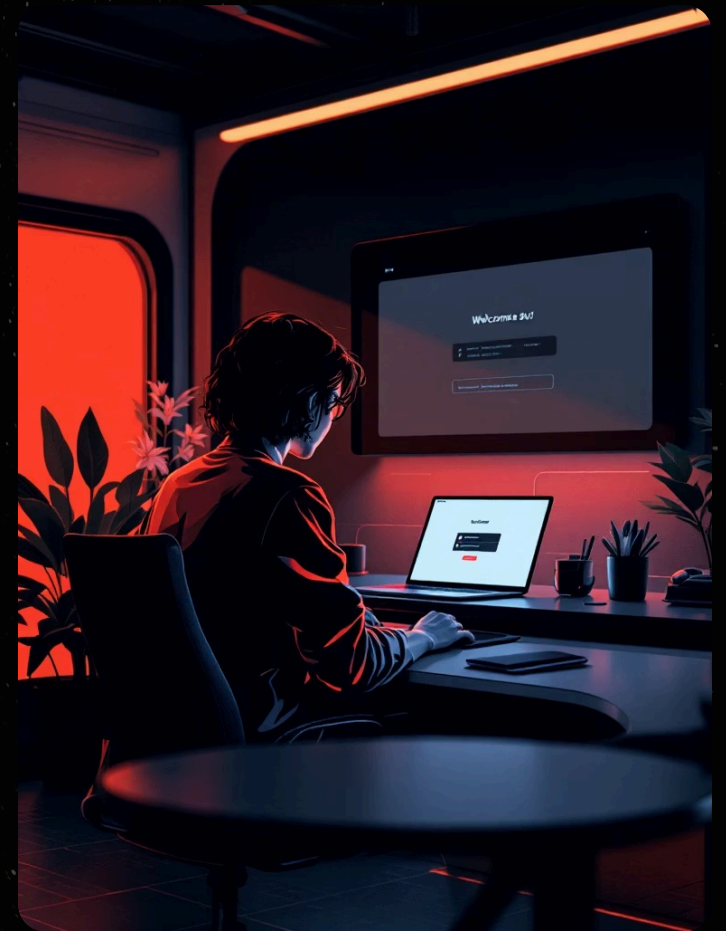
Layer 1 — Product Activation

First Tagged Annotation Rate

Percentage of new signups who create their first tagged annotation within 7 days.

Why it matters: Measures whether onboarding converts curious users into active thinkers.

Target: 40%+ in the first 6 months



L1 Metrics: Engagement Layers

Layer 2 — Self-Knowledge Loop

Profile Engagement

Percentage of weekly active annotators who open their thinking profile or weekly digest

Measures whether self-knowledge creates reason to return beyond individual articles

Confluence Discovery

Percentage of WAA who experience at least one confluence moment per month

The social layer's health metric. Below ~1 confluence every 2–3 weeks, the magic moment fails to hook users

L1 Metrics: Annotation Quality

Layer 3 — Cognitive Fingerprint



Annotation Depth

Average word count per annotation

- Shallow annotations (under 10 words) suggest users treat Nota like a highlighter, not a thought-capture tool
- Depth predicts retention and cognitive fingerprint quality
- Quality annotations feed better confluence matching